

things will work out.

The period when many women choose to start a family is also when they move into more senior roles and take on greater responsibilities. That is why women need encouragement, support and confidence to stay on the path.

Q: How important is culture in driving overall successful organisational change?
A: For me, culture becomes real when it is reflected in everyday decisions—how growth is pursued, how risk is managed, how capital is allocated and how accountability is upheld. During our transformation journey, we reinforced a few non-negotiables—integrity, disciplined execution, collaboration across businesses and functions, prudent risk management, capital efficiency, and a digital-first, customer-first mindset.

We embedded these behaviours through our 'I'M ABC' culture framework, where I' stands for Integrity, 'M' stands for Mindset-Digital, 'A' stands for Accountability and Ownership, 'B' stands for Being Collaborative and Sensitive and 'C' is for Customer-First Approach. We also aligned governance, performance metrics and incentives with these behaviours. We keep reiterating these values in our interactions with employees. Even when we hire people, we assess these attributes.

Q: What is the biggest challenge you see?
A: The [financial] markets are extremely volatile right now. What worries me more today are the external challenges, what is happening around the world and the impact that can have on India, the financial sector and, in turn, on us.

Q: How do you see these external challenges from an India perspective? We do see a lot of concerns: whether it is rupee or foreign inflows, among other things.
A: I am a born optimist. And I really believe there is a huge amount of resilience in India. So, I don't see anything different happening this time. India's underlying economic fundamentals are stronger today. The country has made significant progress in technology and digital infrastructure, while corporate balance sheets are healthier and relatively less leveraged, improving their ability to withstand periods of uncertainty. While global uncertainty and elevated commodity prices could have some impact, India is in a much stronger position to absorb these pressures.

Q: In your journey, what was the toughest decision you had to take?
A: One of the toughest decisions, I would have taken in my life, was whether to attend my child's PTA (parent teacher association) meeting or an important meeting in the office. Managing personal and professional commitments is always tough. BT

@TheNachiket

NOTE *The rank is based on* BT*'s proprietary methodology involving profit after tax, profit growth, and operating profit margin, focusing on profitability as the key metric to judge performance*